Answer key

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCEEXAMINATION APRIL 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) – MG2MDCSSD100-ANUPRAYUKTHYOG

1.समाधौ।

2.क्लेशकर्मविपाकाशयैरपरामृष्टः पुरुषविशेषः ईश्वरः ।

3. वीतरागविषयं ।

4. अपरिग्रहः यमेषु पञ्चमः। अहिंसासत्यास्तेयब्रह्मचर्यापरिग्रहा यमाः।अर्थः: परिग्रहः नाम विषयाणां स्वीकारः, सञ्चयः।अ-परिग्रहः = देह-यात्रा-अतिरिक्त-भोग-साधनानाम् अनङ्गीकारः, लोभ-अभावः।अपरिग्रह-स्थैर्ये जन्मकथन्तासम्बोधः ।।

5. Asana- Pranayama – Pratyahra,Dhara na

6. सन्तोषादनुत्तमसुखलाभः ।

7. Śavāsana relaxes the entire body and mind, removes fatigue, and integrates the benefits of the yoga practice by bringing the nervous system into deep rest.

8. Hold Bhujangāsana for 15-30 seconds initially, breathing normally; with practice it can be held up to 1 minute.

9.Shoulder stand is called Sarvāṅgāsana in Sanskrit.

10. Vajrāsana means thunderbolt pose or diamond pose

11. Viparyayo mithyā-jñānam atad-rūpa-pratiṣṭham

Viparyaya is false knowledge, founded on a form which is not its own.

12.Tatra sthitau yatno abhyāsaḥ. Of these two — abhyāsa and vairāgya — the effort toward steadiness of mind is abhyāsa. Patañjali says _citta-vṛtti-nirodha_ is attained by _abhyāsa_ and _vairāgya_. Sūtra 1.13 defines _abhyāsa_. Abhyāsa is the effort to remain firmly established in that tranquil state of mind.

13. Definitions of Āsana, Prāṇāyāma, and Pratyāhāra

_From Patañjali's Yoga Sūtra, Sādhana Pāda_1. Āsana - Seat/Posture Sūtra 2.46: _Sthira-sukham āsanam.Posture is steady and comfortable.2. Prāṇāyāma - Breath Regulation.Sūtra 2.49:Tasmin sati śvāsa-praśvāsayor gati-vicchedaḥ prāṇāyāmaḥ.

When āsana is accomplished, prāṇāyāma is the cutting off of the movement of inhalation and exhalation. 3. Pratyāhāra - Withdrawal of Senses: Sūtra 2.54: _Sva-viṣaya-asamprayoge cittasya svarūpa-anukāraḥ iva indriyāṇāṁ pratyāhāraḥ."When the senses do not come into contact with their objects, they follow, as it were, the nature of the mind. This is pratyāhāra."

14. Niyama is the second limb of Patañjali's Aṣṭāṅga Yoga_ 2.29. There are five Niyamas, listed in Yoga Sūtra_2.32: Śauca-santoṣa-tapaḥ-svādhyāya-īśvara-praṇidhānāni niyamāḥ. While Yamas are universal restraints in relation to others, Niyamasare personal observances for self-discipline. Together they purify behavior and attitude, making the mind fit for āsana, prāṇāyāma and the inner limbs.

15.Paschimottanasana improves digestion by compressing the abdominal organs during the forward fold, which massages the stomach, intestines, liver, and pancreas, stimulating agni or digestive fire and enhancing peristalsis. The pose also activates the parasympathetic nervous system, reducing stress-related digestive issues like bloating and constipation, while the gentle pressure helps relieve trapped gas and improves blood circulation to the digestive tract.

16. Gomukhāsana improves posture by directly opening the chest and stretching the tight muscles . The arm position draws the shoulder blades down and together, counteracting rounded shoulders from desk work, and the lifted spine encourages length through the thoracic region. With the hips and legs grounded, the pose also balances pelvic alignment, so the benefits extend from the sit bones to the crown of the head, training the body to maintain an upright, open-chested stance even after leave the mat.

17. Padmāsana improves blood circulation by redirecting blood flow through the way the legs are folded and locked. With the ankles pressing against the femoral arteries near the groin, circulation to the lower legs is gently restricted, which increases venous return and channels more blood toward the abdominal and pelvic organs — the digestive system,

reproductive organs, and spine. The upright, stable spine in the pose also reduces muscular effort needed for sitting, calming the nervous system and allowing the heart to pump more efficiently without the strain of poor posture. Over time, this enhanced flow to the core helps reduce swelling in the legs and promotes better oxygenation of the vital organs.

18.In Patañjali's Yoga Sūtra, samādhi is the culmination of the eight-limbed path of yoga. It is divided into two principal stages: samprajñāta and asamprajñāta. While samprajñāta samādhi is "cognitive" absorption with a support or object, asamprajñāta samādhi is the higher, objectless state often called nirbīja samādhi or "seedless absorption". It represents the threshold of kaivalya, the final liberation of the seer from identification with prakṛti.

Patañjali defines it in Yoga Sūtra1.18: Virāma-pratyaya-abhyāsa-pūrvaḥ saṁskāra-śeṣo anyaḥ."The other samādhi, preceded by the practice of the notion of cessation, has only residual impressions."Vyāsa's commentary clarifies: here every vṛtti_of the mind, including the subtle supports used in samprajñāta samādhi, has ceased. Only saṁskāraslatent impressions — remain, but even they are inactive. Because no new mental content arises, it isasamprajñāta, "beyond cognition". It is nirbīja, "seedless," because the seeds of future karma and rebirth the kleśas and their saṁskāras are rendered steri.

Samprajñāta samādhi still operates within the realm of prakṛti. It has four stages based on the object of meditation: _vitarka_ with gross objects, _vicāra_ with subtle, _ānanda_ with bliss, and _asmitā_ with pure I-sense 1.17. The mind is one-pointed, but still dependent on an _ālambana_, a support.In asamprajñāta, that support itself is dropped. The method is _virāma-pratyaya_ — the "idea of cessation". The yogi repeatedly turns awareness to the gap between thoughts, to the cessation itself, until the habit of cognition dissolves. What remains is not unconsciousness, but pure awareness without content. Hence it is also called nirvikalpa samādhi in later traditions.

Patañjali gives two routes to asamprajñāta in 1.19-1.20:

1. Bhava-pratyaya: For _videhas_ and _prakṛti-layas_,

2. Upāya-pratyaya

Asamprajñāta samādhi is the pinnacle of _citta-vṛtti-nirodha_. By relinquishing even the subtlest supports of meditation through para-vairāgya, the yogi enters seedless absorption where only cessation remains. From this silence, the saṁskāras that bind consciousness to rebirth are dissolved, and the _puruṣa_ stands free. It is therefore both a practice and a state: the ultimate letting-go that reveals what was never bound.

19. In Aṣṭāṅga Yoga, _yama_ forms the ethical foundation — the first limb without which the later limbs cannot mature. Patañjali lists five yamas: _ahiṁsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya,_ and _aparigraha_ 2.30. These are called _mahāvrata_, the “great vows,” when practiced universally without exception 2.31. When a yama becomes _pratiṣṭhā_, firmly established in the yogi’s being, it yields specific _siddhis_ or fruits that are both psychological transformations and objective changes in the yogi’s environment. Patañjali dedicates sūtras 2.35-2.39 to these achievements.

1. Ahiṁsā-pratiṣṭhāyāṁ tat-sannidhau vaira-tyāgaḥ 2.35*

When non-violence is firmly established, hostility is abandoned in the yogi’s presence.

Achievement: Ahiṁsā is not mere abstention from killing. When it becomes a state of mind free from the very saṁskāra of harm, the yogi’s vibration of peace is so potent that even natural enemies drop their enmity. Classical commentaries cite examples of tigers and deer drinking together near sages. Psychologically, the yogi becomes incapable of reaction, and the field around him reflects that absence of violence. This is the first sign that yoga is not escapism, but changes the fabric of relationships.

2. Satya-pratiṣṭhāyāṁ kriyā-phala-āśrayatvam 2.36*

When truthfulness is firmly established, action and result come to depend on the yogi.

Achievement: Satya here means correspondence between thought, word, and deed, rooted in seeing things as they are. When it is perfected, the yogi’s word gains _vāk-siddhi_. Speech is no longer separate from reality, so whatever he says tends to manifest. Vyāsa says: if he tells a virtuous person “Be righteous,” the person becomes righteous; if he tells a sick person “Be healed,” health follows. This is not magic, but the power of a mind without self-deception — a mind aligned with _ṛta_, cosmic order.

3. Asteya-pratiṣṭhāyāṁ sarva-ratna-upasthānam 2.37*

When non-stealing is firmly established, all jewels present themselves.

Achievement: Asteya is freedom from covetousness, even in thought. When the yogi truly wants nothing that is not his, the sense of lack ends. The sūtra indicates that wealth in all forms — material, intellectual, spiritual — flows toward such a person unsought. Because he has no “hole” of desire, prakṛti fills him. On a practical level, trustworthiness attracts resources, opportunities, and people’s confidence.

4. Brahmacarya-pratiṣṭhāyāṁ vīrya-lābhaḥ 2.38 Ceibacy/continence is firmly established, vigor is gained.

Achievement: Brahmacarya is literally “moving in Brahman.” It means conserving and sublimating life-energy instead of dissipating it through the senses. When firmly established, the yogi gains _vīrya_ — not just physical stamina, but intellectual brilliance, unshakable will, and spiritual power to transmit knowledge. The nervous system, no longer depleted, can hold higher states of samādhi. Thus brahmacarya becomes the battery for all other limbs.

5. Aparigraha-sthairye janma-kathantā-sambodhaḥ 2.39

When non-possessiveness is stabilized, knowledge of the ‘how’ of births arises.

Achievement: Aparigraha is freedom from accumulation, seeing the defects in hoarding: anxiety of acquiring, protecting, losing, and attachment. When it is stable, the craving that drives rebirth is thinned. Consequently, memory of past lives dawns, because the veil of _tṛṣṇā_ that caused identification with one body lifts. The yogi understands the causal chain of his births — “how and why I was born” — which accelerates dispassion and progress to kaivalya.

The five siddhis show that morality in yoga is not imposed social rule, but _natural law_. Each yama removes a specific color of _kleśa_: violence from dveṣa, lying from rāga-dveṣa, stealing from lobha, incontinence from kāma, hoarding from abhiniveśa. As the kleśas thin, the powers appear spontaneously, without being sought. Hence Patañjali never calls them “miracles”; they are _pariṇāma_, natural transformations of a purified citta.

Moreover, the yamas protect the yogi and society. A person established in yama becomes a sanctuary others feel safe, truthful, generous near him. Thus the first limb itself begins _loka-saṅgraha_, welfare of the world.

Conclusion

Firmly established yamas are not the end of yoga, but they prove that inner transformation has external consequence. They convert ethics into energy: ahiṁsā into peace, satya into creative word, asteya into abundance, brahmacarya into power, aparigraha into wisdom. These achievements are milestones that the mind is ready for āsana, prāṇāyāma, and the inward limbs. In that sense, the “fruits of yama” are both grace and verification — evidence that the yogi is no longer practicing yoga, but has begun to become yoga itself.

20.Jānuśīrṣāsana – Methods & Benefits

Method of Practice

1. Sit in _Daṇḍāsana_ with legs extended straight, spine erect, palms beside hips.

2. Fold one leg: Bend the left knee and place the left sole against the inner right thigh. Left heel touches the perineum, left knee rests on the floor. Keep both sit bones grounded.

3. Square the torso: Turn your torso slightly so the navel aligns with the center of the right thigh, not twisted to the side.

4. Inhale & lengthen: Raise both arms overhead, stretch the spine upward, lift the chest.

5. Exhale & fold: Hinging from the hips, not the waist, extend forward over the right leg. Catch the right foot, ankle, or shin — wherever you reach without rounding the back.

6. Head position: In the final pose, forehead rests toward the knee/shin. Keep the right foot flexed, toes pointing up.

7. Hold: Breathe slowly for 30 sec – 2 min. Keep the back as long as possible. With each exhale, soften deeper into the fold.

8.Release: Inhale, lift the torso up. Exhale, release arms. Repeat on the other side.

Key Alignment Points:

Don't force: If hamstrings are tight, bend the straight knee slightly or use a strap around the foot.

Spine first: Aim to bring the belly to the thigh before the head to the knee. A rounded spine defeats the benefit.

Grounded knee: The bent knee should stay on the floor. Place a folded blanket under it if needed.

Contraindications: Avoid with slipped disc, sciatica, acute knee injury, asthma attack, or diarrhea. Pregnant women should keep the legs wide and not compress the abdomen.

Benefits:Jānuśīrṣāsana combines a therapeutic abdominal massage with a deep spinal and hamstring release, calming the mind while toning the digestive organs*. Practiced regularly, it brings flexibility to the body and tranquility to the mind.

21.Chakrāsana – Methods of Practice

This is a deep backbend that forms a wheel-like arch with the body. It requires flexibility in the spine, shoulders, and wrists, plus strength in the arms and legs. Always warm up first.

Method 1: From Lying Down – Standard Method.Best for beginners to intermediate

1. Start: Lie on your back in _Śavāsana_. Bend both knees, bring heels close to the buttocks, hip-width apart. Feet flat and parallel.

2. Hand placement: Bend elbows, place palms on the floor beside your ears. Fingers point toward shoulders. Elbows point up, shoulder-width.

3. Inhale & lift: Press firmly into palms and feet. On an inhale, lift the hips, then the torso and head off the floor. Crown of the head rests lightly on the floor. Pause this is bridge on head.

4. Full pose: Exhale. Press more into hands and feet, straighten the arms, and lift the head completely off the floor. Come into a full arch.

5. Align: Keep feet parallel, knees over ankles. Try to straighten elbows and knees as much as possible. Push the chest toward the wall behind you. Gaze to the floor or between hands.

6. Hold: Breathe normally for 10-30 seconds initially. Don't hold the breath.

7. Release: Tuck chin to chest, bend elbows and knees slowly, and lower the spine vertebra by vertebra upper back, middle back, then hips. Rest in Śavāsanaor hug knees to chest to neutralize.

Method 2: From Standing – Advanced.Only after mastering the lying version

1. Start: Stand in _Tāḍāsana_ with feet hip-width, a wall 2-3 feet behind you.

2. Arms up: Inhale, raise arms overhead. Lift chest, look up.

3. Bend back: Exhale, push hips forward and begin arching back. Keep thighs and buttocks firm.

4. Walk down: Place hands on the wall, and slowly walk them down toward the floor. Keep breathing.

5. To floor: When hands reach the floor, adjust feet if needed and press into full Chakrāsana.

6. Come up: To exit, either walk hands back up the wall, or drop to the floor and lower as in Method 1.

Method 3: With Partner/Props For Support. Wall: Lie with head near a wall. In step 4, place hands on the wall first, then press up. Reduces fear and wrist strain. Blocks: Place 2 blocks against a wall at 45°. Rest hands on blocks to reduce wrist extension. Partner: A partner

can stand by your hips, hands under your sacrum, and help lift you until your arms gain strength.

Key Alignment & Safety Points: Warm-up mandatory*: Do Bhujangāsana, Setu Bandhāsana, Uṣṭrāsana, and shoulder openers first.

Weight distribution: 60% on legs, 40% on arms. If wrists hurt, shift more weight to legs.

Don’t: Force the arms straight if shoulders are tight. Don’t let knees splay out — keep them hip-width.

Neck: Keep it neutral. Don’t hang the head or compress the cervical spine.

Contraindications: Avoid with wrist, shoulder, or back injury, high BP, heart problems, hernia, vertigo, recent surgery, or pregnancy.

Counterpose: Always follow with a gentle forward bend like Bālāsana or Paścimottānāsana to release the spine.

Practiced correctly, Chakrāsana builds strength, opens the chest and heart area, stimulates the nervous system, and improves spinal flexibility.